

Reiner Lorch

Senior Backend Engineer | Python, Django, FastAPI, Kubernetes, AWS

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SUMMARY

Backend engineer with ten years of experience building high-throughput services for Berlin-based scale-ups and a major e-commerce platform. Proven track record of reducing API latency by 40 %, cutting infrastructure cost by 25 %, and scaling event-driven systems to 2 M req/s. Strong advocate of test-driven development, observability, and platform-level automation.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Engineer · Personio, Berlin, Germany

2024 – Present

- Redesigned the core HR-API using FastAPI and PostgreSQL, cutting 95th-percentile latency from 320 ms to 180 ms (-44 %).
- Migrated 12 micro-services to EKS with Terraform-managed clusters, reducing monthly cloud spend by €45 k (-27 %).
- Introduced contract-testing with Pact across 8 teams, decreasing integration-failure rate in staging from 12 % to 3 %.
- Led a 5-person squad that delivered a real-time notification pipeline on Kafka handling 1.2 M events/day with 99.99 % uptime.

Lead Backend Engineer · Delivery Hero, Berlin, Germany

2021 – 2024

- Architected the order-orchestration service (Django + Kafka) processing 2.5 M orders/day, achieving 99.95 % SLA.
- Implemented automated canary deployments with Argo Rollouts, cutting rollback time from 15 min to 2 min.
- Optimized PostgreSQL query plans and added read-replicas, lowering average DB CPU from 78 % to 42 %.
- Mentored 4 junior engineers and established an internal “Backend Guild” that produced 3 reusable libraries adopted company-wide.

Backend Engineer · Zalando, Berlin, Germany

2018 – 2021

- Built the product-catalog search API (FastAPI + Elasticsearch) serving 500 k req/s with sub-50 ms latency.
- Refactored legacy Django monolith into 7 bounded-context services, reducing deployment frequency from weekly to daily.
- Designed a CDC pipeline with Debezium → Kafka → Snowflake, enabling near-real-time analytics for 120 M SKUs.
- Contributed to the internal Kubernetes platform (Zalando-Kube), adding custom admission controllers that enforced resource quotas for 200+ teams.

Junior Backend Engineer · N26, Berlin, Germany

2016 – 2018

- Developed the transaction-enrichment service (Python/Django) processing 3 M transactions/day, adding merchant categorisation with 92 % accuracy.
- Automated CI/CD pipelines on GitLab, cutting build-to-deploy time from 45 min to 12 min.
- Implemented circuit-breaker patterns with Hystrix for external payment-gateway calls, reducing cascade failures by 68 %.
- Participated in on-call rotation for a 12-person team, maintaining 99.9 % availability for core banking APIs.

SKILLS

Python 3.11 · Django 4.2 · FastAPI · PostgreSQL 15 ·
Apache Kafka 3.6 · Docker · Kubernetes (EKS, GKE) ·
AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda, CloudWatch) · Redis 7 ·
Elasticsearch 8 · GraphQL (Strawberry) · Terraform ·
Prometheus & Grafana · GitLab CI/CD · Microservices
architecture · Event-driven design · Domain-driven design ·
OpenTelemetry

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science

Technische Universität Berlin, 2014–2016

LANGUAGES

German (Native)

English (C1)

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate (2023)

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) (2022)